a brief conversation with Virat Kohli during the IPL.

I had arrived at breakfast one morning and sat down beside my friend, the player of the tournament, who was already at the table.

'So I was wondering,' I said, out of the blue, 'how long do you think you're going to keep playing cricket?'

Virat's face broke into a beaming smile, his eyes alight.

'I'm going to play forever,' he replied.

'If only that were possible,' I smiled, 'if only that were possible.'